

INDIGENOUS DISABILITY IN ALBERTA

A Plain Language Guide

For Indigenous Albertans, Their Families, Support Workers, and Allies



This guide is for everyone.

If you are Indigenous and live with a disability in Alberta — this explains what the disability system looks like for you, and what is changing on July 1, 2026.

If you support someone Indigenous with a disability — this shows you where the system was built to fail them, and how to help.

If you are a friend, neighbour, or ally — this tells you a story that is still happening, in your province, right now.

Every page has a green box at the end that gives you words to use.

Alberta Disability System Breakdown — April 2026

A Note Before You Read

Some of what is in this guide is hard to read. It talks about residential schools, about children being taken from families, about missing and murdered people, about life expectancy.

It does this because the disability system Indigenous Albertans live in today was built on top of those histories. You cannot understand why the system fails people without understanding what it was built to do.

This guide is not written to shock you. It is written to name things plainly, so that when someone in your community is being told *"this is just how it is,"* you have the words to say: **no, this is something that was done, and it is still being done.**

If any page becomes too much, skip it. Come back to it later. Or don't. What matters is that this information exists, and that it is free, and that it can be read aloud.

PAGE 1 — WHAT THIS GUIDE IS ABOUT



THE DISABILITY SYSTEM WAS NOT BUILT FOR INDIGENOUS ALBERTANS. THIS GUIDE EXPLAINS WHY.

This guide is a short version of a much longer report. The long report is 195 pages. It has footnotes, sources, court cases, and government documents.

This is the plain language version. It covers the same ground, in simpler words.

The long report asks one question: **what happens to Indigenous Albertans when the disability system changes on July 1, 2026?**

The answer is in this guide.

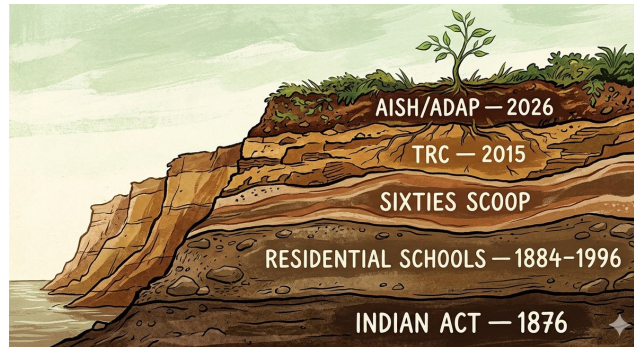
Why a separate guide for Indigenous Albertans?

The disability system fails everyone in different ways. But for Indigenous Albertans, it fails in *specific* ways that come from *specific* history. Residential schools. Indian Hospitals. The Sixties Scoop. Treaty rights that were promised and not kept. The system was built during those things, and it still acts like those things never happened.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "There is a 195-page report on how Alberta's disability system affects Indigenous people. This is the short version. It is free, and it can be read aloud to anyone who needs it."

PAGE 2 — A LITTLE HISTORY



THE DISABILITY RATES WE SEE TODAY DID NOT HAPPEN BY ACCIDENT.

Three things happened over the last 150 years that directly affect Indigenous health today:

Residential schools — From 1831 to 1996, Canada took more than 150,000 Indigenous children from their families and put them in church-run schools. Children were beaten, starved, and abused. Many died. Some schools had death rates as high as 69%. One was in Alberta.

Indian Hospitals — From the 1920s to the 1980s, Canada ran a separate hospital system for Indigenous people, funded at about two-thirds the rate of regular hospitals. Two were in Alberta: the Charles Camsell in Edmonton, and the Blackfoot Hospital at Cardston. Some survivors are still alive.

The Sixties Scoop — From the 1960s to the 1980s, child welfare workers took tens of thousands of Indigenous children from their families and placed them with non-Indigenous families, often far from home.

The people who lived through these things are alive today. Some are on AISH. Some are being moved to ADAP on July 1, 2026.

Why this matters for a disability guide

These three systems did not just hurt people's feelings. They produced real bodily harm — illness, injury, malnutrition, trauma that was passed down to children and grandchildren. The disability rates among Indigenous Albertans are high *because* of what was done. The government knows this. The government wrote it down. And the disability system still acts like none of it happened.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "The reason Indigenous people in Alberta have more disabilities on average is not genetics. It is what was done to them by governments. The system that is supposed to help now is still the same system that helped do it."

PAGE 3 — THE 19-YEAR GAP



FIRST NATIONS PEOPLE IN ALBERTA LIVE 19 YEARS LESS THAN OTHER ALBERTANS. THAT GAP IS GETTING WIDER.

In 2023, the average life expectancy for First Nations people in Alberta was **62.8 years**. For other Albertans, it was **81.9 years**. That is a **19-year gap** — the widest on record.

The gap was about 7 years in 1999. It grew to 12 years by 2019. Then COVID hit — and for First Nations Albertans, life expectancy dropped by 7 years in 2 years. For other Albertans, it dropped by 1.4 years.

A government-funded advisory panel in Alberta said in 2022 that First Nations life expectancy in the province is *"in alignment with countries like Niger, Angola, and Afghanistan, and similar to life expectancy in Canada during the Great Depression in the 1930s."*

That is an official government comparison. Not advocacy. Not exaggeration.

What does this mean for disability policy?

ADAP is being designed around an employment-focused model — with the assumption that people will work into their 50s and 60s and age into older-age benefits. But First Nations men in Alberta are dying at an average of 60 years old. The program is being built for a life course that, for many Indigenous Albertans, doesn't exist.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "First Nations people in Alberta die 19 years earlier than other Albertans. This page is about real numbers, from the government. If you need to take a breath before reading, take one. The numbers are real. So is what causes them."

PAGE 4 — THE JURISDICTIONAL TRAP



WHEN YOU NEED HELP, TWO LEVELS OF GOVERNMENT CAN BOTH SAY "NOT OUR JOB."

Canada has a constitution from 1867. That constitution divided up who is responsible for what.

The federal government (Ottawa) is responsible for **"Indians and lands reserved for Indians."**

The provincial government (Alberta) is responsible for healthcare, housing, education, and social supports — including AISH and ADAP.

If you are Indigenous and disabled, that split creates a problem. You need **healthcare** — provincial. You need **non-insured health benefits** — federal. You need **housing** — federal if on reserve, provincial if in the city. You need **AISH/ADAP** — provincial. You need **Jordan's Principle** for your kids — federal.

Every one of those systems has paperwork. Every one has wait times. Every one can say "that's the other level's job."

The Supreme Court of Canada called this space the **"jurisdictional wasteland"** in 2016 — the space between the federal and provincial systems, where Indigenous people disappear.

Why "wasteland"?

Because applications get lost in it. Because children wait years for care that neither government will pay for. Because people die waiting for a decision that never comes. The word "wasteland" was chosen by the Supreme Court. It is not an opinion. It is a legal finding.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "If you are Indigenous and need help, two levels of government can both say it is the other one's job. That is not accidental. It has been happening for over 100 years. The Supreme Court has a name for it."

PAGE 5 — HOUSING



YOU HAVE TWO CHOICES. BOTH FAIL.

If you are a disabled Indigenous Albertan, your housing options are:

On reserve — federal housing. The Auditor General of Canada has checked this system four times in 20 years. Each time, the answer was the same: not enough money, not enough homes, not enough repairs. Alberta reserves have been underfunded by at least \$141 million since 2008.

Off reserve — Alberta's rental market. Alberta has no rent cap. A one-bedroom apartment costs \$1,500 to \$1,900 a month. AISH pays \$1,940. ADAP will pay \$1,740 after December 2027.

In October 2025, the Alberta government quietly signed an order in council that increased community housing rent by **63%**. Rent for some people went from \$349 a month to \$570 a month. No consultation. No warning.

Edmonton's main affordable housing waitlist — Cvida — has over **10,000 households** on it. Calgary's has over 6,500.

You are not on a list that moves forward. You are on a list that the government controls.

"First come, first served"?

No. Cvida says priority can change at any time. There is no guaranteed wait time. You can be on the list for years. People die waiting.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "There is no housing option that works for a disabled Indigenous person in Alberta. The reserve housing is broken. The city rent is too high. The waitlists are enormous. The government knows all of this."

PAGE 6 — CONTAMINATED LAND



SOME COMMUNITIES ARE LIVING ON LAND THE GOVERNMENT KNOWS IS MAKING THEM SICK.

The Alberta tar sands are the largest industrial project on Earth. They produce billions of litres of toxic waste. That waste leaks into the Athabasca River and into the land around it. Downstream First Nations — including Fort Chipewyan, Fort McKay, and the Athabasca Chipewyan First Nation — have been documenting unusual rates of rare cancers, autoimmune diseases, birth defects, and early death for over 20 years.

The government's own scientists have studied this. The government has not stopped the pollution.

There is scientific evidence now that toxic exposure in one generation can cause health problems in the children and grandchildren of that generation. This means disabilities that show up today can be the direct result of exposure that happened 30 years ago, or 60 years ago, on land the government still refuses to clean up.

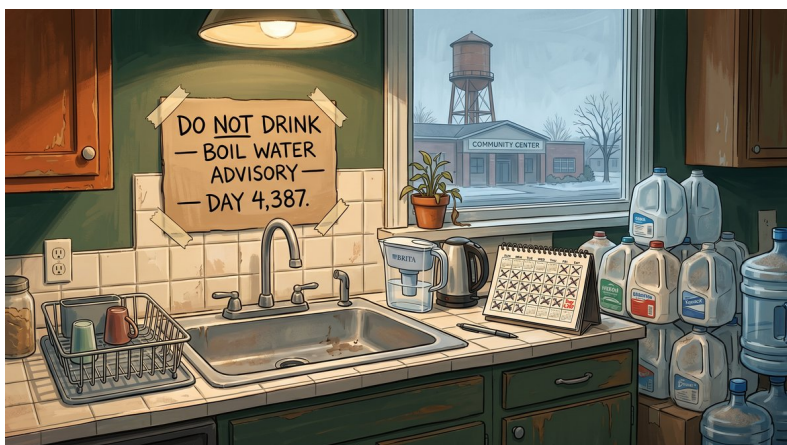
Epigenetics in plain language

Scientists now know that stress, malnutrition, and toxic exposure can leave a mark on a person's cells that gets passed to their children. Not in their DNA itself, but in the switches that turn DNA on and off. That means the harm of contaminated land can show up in grandchildren who never touched the land.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "Some Alberta communities live on land that is making them sick. The government knows. It has been happening for decades. The disabilities you see today can come from pollution that happened before some of the people affected were even born."

PAGE 7 — WATER



SOME FIRST NATIONS IN CANADA HAVE NOT HAD SAFE DRINKING WATER IN OVER 20 YEARS.

As of 2026, there are still **long-term boil water advisories** on many First Nations reserves across Canada. "Long-term" means more than one year. Some advisories have been in place for more than two decades.

In 2024, the federal government proposed Bill C-61, the First Nations Clean Water Act. This would set enforceable standards for drinking water on reserves.

On **July 10, 2025**, the Government of Alberta formally opposed that federal bill. The reason Alberta gave was "**competitiveness**" — that federal water protection rules might interfere with industrial development in the province.

Alberta's position, in plain words: cleaner water for First Nations is a threat to the economy.

Why is this a disability issue?

Because unsafe water causes disease. Because children who grow up drinking contaminated water have higher rates of developmental delays, respiratory illness, and chronic conditions. Because an elder on dialysis cannot dialyze with water that needs to be boiled. Because "safe water" is not an add-on — it is the foundation of every other health measure.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "Some First Nations communities have not had safe drinking water in over 20 years. The federal government is trying to pass a law to fix it. The Alberta government is fighting that law because it might hurt industry. That is a real thing the Alberta government said in 2025."

PAGE 8 — HEALTHCARE



TWO HEALTHCARE SYSTEMS. NEITHER TALKS TO THE OTHER.

If you are Indigenous in Alberta, you have two healthcare systems:

Alberta Health Services (AHS) — the provincial system. Hospitals, doctors, most care.

Non-Insured Health Benefits (NIHB) — a federal program that pays for some medications, dental, vision, and travel for medical care.

These two systems do not talk to each other. You have to navigate both. The paperwork is different. The rules are different.

- **650,000 Albertans** have no family doctor. Indigenous Albertans are overrepresented.
- Between 2019 and 2024, Alberta medical practices accepting new patients dropped from **887 to 164**.
- The 2020 report *In Plain Sight* documented widespread anti-Indigenous racism in healthcare. Findings apply across Canada.
- Statistics Canada 2024 data confirms Indigenous patients face systemic disrespect and worse care outcomes.

What does racism in healthcare actually look like?

It means Indigenous patients getting less pain medication. It means symptoms being dismissed as drug-seeking or alcohol-related. It means women in labour not being believed. It means patients dying in hospital waiting rooms while staff watch. These are documented cases. They are not rare.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "Indigenous people have to deal with two healthcare systems that don't talk to each other, and they also face racism inside those systems. The government knows. There are official reports saying so. Almost nothing has changed."

PAGE 9 — JORDAN'S PRINCIPLE



THIS IS NAMED AFTER A CHILD WHO DIED WAITING FOR CARE. IT IS STILL NOT BEING FOLLOWED.

Jordan River Anderson was a Cree boy from Norway House Cree Nation in Manitoba. He was born in 1999 with complex medical needs. He spent the first two years of his life in a hospital. When doctors said he could go home, the federal and provincial governments fought for over two years about who would pay for his care.

He died in 2005, still in the hospital, at the age of five. He never went home.

In 2007, the House of Commons voted unanimously: from now on, when a First Nations child needs care, the level of government first contacted would pay first and argue about who owed what later. This is called **Jordan's Principle**.

In 2016, the Canadian Human Rights Tribunal ordered Canada to implement it properly. Canada has not. As of late 2024, there were **129,000 Jordan's Principle requests** waiting to be processed. **17,000 of them were urgent.**

In February 2025, Canada issued an operational bulletin narrowing what Jordan's Principle would cover. **Children have died waiting.**

What Jordan's Principle actually is

It is a legal rule. Not a program. Not a charity. Not a nice-to-have. If your Indigenous child needs care and two governments are arguing about who pays, Jordan's Principle says: the first government called pays now, and they sort it out later. That is the law. It has been the law since 2016. It is being ignored.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "There is a law called Jordan's Principle. It is named after a little boy who died waiting for care because two governments were arguing about money. The law is still not being followed. Children are still dying."

PAGE 10 — CHILD WELFARE



INDIGENOUS CHILDREN ARE STILL BEING TAKEN. IN ALBERTA, THEY ARE 72% OF THE CHILD WELFARE SYSTEM.

The Sixties Scoop did not end. It changed names.

Indigenous children make up **7.7%** of Alberta's child population.

They make up **72%** of Alberta's child welfare caseload.

Indigenous children in Alberta are taken from their families at **17 times the rate** of non-Indigenous children.

In 2019, the federal government passed **Bill C-92**, a law recognizing First Nations' own jurisdiction over child welfare. Twenty-two **Delegated First Nations Agencies** now operate in Alberta.

But in October 2024, **267 First Nations chiefs rejected** the federal government's \$47.8 billion settlement offer on child welfare reform. They said the money was not enough to fix what was broken.

Child welfare involvement is itself a **disability risk factor**. Children who are removed experience higher rates of mental illness, addiction, suicide, and chronic disease. Many will become the next generation of AISH recipients.

The cycle that will not stop

A disability in a parent can be used as a reason to take a child. A child who is taken can develop a disability from the trauma. That disabled adult will then be supported — or not supported — by a system like ADAP. And if that adult has their own children, the cycle begins again.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "Three out of every four children in Alberta's child welfare system are Indigenous. That is not because Indigenous parents are worse. It is because the system is still doing what the Sixties Scoop did. It has been this way for generations."

PAGE 11 — JUSTICE



INDIGENOUS PEOPLE ARE OVERREPRESENTED IN PRISONS. DISABILITY MAKES IT WORSE.

Indigenous people are about **5%** of Canada's population.

They are **32%** of people in federal prisons.

Indigenous women are over **50%** of women in federal prisons.

If an Indigenous person also has a cognitive or mental health disability, their risk goes up more. Police often do not recognize disability symptoms. Courts often do not accommodate them. Lawyers often do not ask.

The result: disabled Indigenous people get arrested more, charged more, convicted more, and sentenced to longer prison terms than others.

When they come out, they often cannot access disability supports because of their criminal record. Many end up homeless. Many end up back inside.

Criminalization of disability

A person in mental health crisis gets a police response, not a medical response. A person with a cognitive disability does not understand what is being asked in an interrogation. A person with autism is "non-compliant." A person with FASD is "a repeat offender." The system was built to process these people — not to help them.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "One in three people in Canada's federal prisons is Indigenous. Disability makes things worse, not better, inside the justice system. People come out with fewer supports than they went in with. The system is not fixing anything."

PAGE 12 — MISSING AND MURDERED



IN 2019, A FEDERAL INQUIRY FOUND THE SITUATION OF INDIGENOUS WOMEN IN CANADA MEETS THE LEGAL DEFINITION OF GENOCIDE.

This is the hardest page.

In 2016, Canada started a national inquiry into Missing and Murdered Indigenous Women, Girls, and Two-Spirit people. **MMIWG2S.**

In 2019, the inquiry released its report. It found that the ongoing violence against Indigenous women and girls in Canada **meets the legal definition of genocide** under the UN Convention on the Prevention and Punishment of the Crime of Genocide (1948).

That is a formal legal finding. Not an opinion. Not activism.

The report made **231 Calls for Justice**. As of 2026, almost none have been fully implemented.

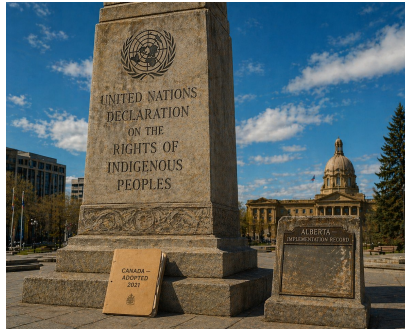
Why does this belong in a disability guide? Because Indigenous women with disabilities — especially cognitive or mental health disabilities — are at the highest risk of going missing or being murdered. ADAP cuts income support, removes caseworkers, takes away appeal rights, and increases housing instability. Every one of those is a documented MMIWG2S+ risk factor.

The red dress

You may see red dresses hanging from trees, from fences, at bus stops, in public spaces. Each one represents a woman or girl who is missing or was murdered. The image on this page is one of those dresses. The offerings at the base — sage, a candle, a note, stones — are for the person the dress represents.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "There is a federal inquiry that found Canada is committing genocide against Indigenous women. That is not advocacy language — it is the legal finding. And the disability system cuts the people most at risk of that violence. This is the hardest page in this guide. Take your time with it."



CANADA SIGNED A UN DECLARATION PROMISING TO CONSULT INDIGENOUS PEOPLE BEFORE MAKING LAWS THAT AFFECT THEM. ALBERTA DID NOT CONSULT.

UNDRIP stands for the **United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples**.

Canada enacted the UNDRIP Act in **June 2021**. That law requires Canadian laws to be made consistent with UNDRIP.

Article 19: governments shall consult with Indigenous peoples to obtain their **free, prior, and informed consent** before adopting laws or policies that may affect them.

Article 21: Indigenous peoples have the right, **without discrimination**, to the improvement of their economic and social conditions.

The ADAP transition is a legislative measure affecting an estimated **79,290 Albertans**, including a significant Indigenous population.

There was no consent process. There was no consultation process.

A few meetings with advocacy groups in late 2024 and early 2025. No formal engagement with Treaty 6, 7, or 8 nations. No formal engagement with the Métis Nation of Alberta. No free, prior, and informed consent.

What "consultation" actually means

It is not a meeting to announce a decision. It is not a survey. It is not a public comment period. It is meeting with Indigenous leadership, explaining what is being considered, listening to their response, and — this is the key part — *being prepared to change the plan if they say no*. None of that happened with ADAP.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "Canada signed a UN declaration saying governments have to consult with Indigenous people before making laws that affect them. The ADAP change affects about 79,000 Albertans, many of them Indigenous. There was no consultation. That is a breach of a UN declaration Canada itself agreed to."

PAGE 14 — SOVEREIGNTY



INDIGENOUS NATIONS ARE NATIONS. DECISIONS ABOUT DISABILITY SUPPORTS ARE ALSO TREATY MATTERS.

The treaties between the Crown and First Nations in Alberta are **nation-to-nation agreements**. Treaty 6, Treaty 7, and Treaty 8 cover almost all of the land that is now called Alberta.

Those treaties include the "**medicine chest clause**" (Treaty 6) and broader commitments around health, welfare, and livelihood. The modern interpretation includes a federal responsibility for Indigenous health.

In 2022, Alberta passed the **Sovereignty Act**. This law allows the province to refuse to follow federal laws it considers unconstitutional.

In 2025, Alberta used this framework to resist federal Indigenous water protection, federal environmental rules, and federal drug decriminalization policy.

Alberta is asserting *its own* sovereignty against the federal government — while actively undermining Indigenous sovereignty within its borders. **This is a contradiction**, and it matters for disability supports.

What self-determination means in practice

It means a First Nation deciding how disability supports work for its members. Who qualifies. What counts as disability. How the support is delivered. In Canadian law, this authority exists. In Alberta practice, it is rarely recognized. The ADAP transition did not include any nation-to-nation engagement on this question.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "Alberta uses a Sovereignty Act to resist federal laws it doesn't like. But it doesn't respect Indigenous nations' sovereignty in the same way. Indigenous nations have the right to run their own disability supports. That right was not respected in the ADAP design."

PAGE 15 — TRC CALLS TO ACTION



11 YEARS AGO, THE TRC MADE 94 CALLS TO ACTION. MOST ARE STILL UNDONE.

The **Truth and Reconciliation Commission (TRC)** concluded in 2015 after six years of work, 6,500 survivor testimonies, and five million federal records reviewed.

It produced **94 Calls to Action**. These are specific things governments, institutions, and Canadians were asked to do.

Calls to Action 18 through 24 focus on health:

- Call 18 — acknowledge that the current state of Indigenous health is a direct result of previous government policies
- Call 19 — set measurable goals to close the health gap
- Call 22 — recognize Indigenous healing practices
- Call 23 — increase Indigenous healthcare professionals
- Call 24 — teach medical and nursing schools about Indigenous health and residential schools

As of 2026 — **11 years after the TRC finished its work** — most of these Calls are still not implemented. The Calls are not advocacy. They are the findings of a federal commission. The government's own work.

Why the TRC Calls matter for ADAP

Because Call 18 says governments must acknowledge that Indigenous health today is a direct result of previous government policies. ADAP was designed without that acknowledgment. It treats Indigenous Albertans as if the historical context didn't exist. That is not a gap in analysis — it is a refusal to follow a Call to Action the government already received.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "In 2015, a federal commission gave the government 94 specific things to do about residential schools and Indigenous health. Eleven years later, most are still undone. ADAP was designed as if those 94 things didn't exist."

PAGE 16 — JULY 1, 2026



EVERY THREAD IN THIS GUIDE ARRIVES AT ONE DATE. JULY 1, 2026.

On **July 1, 2026** — a date Canada calls "Canada Day" — every person on AISH in Alberta will be automatically moved to ADAP.

Every failure documented in this guide arrives at that date:

- Historical harm from residential schools (Page 2)
- 19-year mortality gap (Page 3)
- Jurisdictional wasteland (Page 4)
- Housing crisis with 10,000-person waitlists (Page 5)
- Contaminated land producing disability (Page 6)
- Water crisis Alberta is fighting (Page 7)
- Dual healthcare system (Page 8)
- Jordan's Principle 129,000 backlog (Page 9)
- Child welfare 72% Indigenous (Page 10)
- Justice overrepresentation (Page 11)
- MMIWG2S genocide finding (Page 12)
- UNDRIP consultation skipped (Page 13)
- Treaty rights not recognized (Page 14)
- TRC Calls still undone (Page 15)

79,290 people are being moved. A significant share are Indigenous. They will be moved with no plan, no accommodation, no consultation, no acknowledgment, and no exception.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "On July 1, 2026, every failure this guide has described is going to be forced through one more time — all at once, on the same day, to the same people. The campaign is asking for it to stop until the process is done properly."

PAGE 17 — FEDERAL CLAWBACK



THE FEDERAL GOVERNMENT SENDS MONEY. ALBERTA TAKES IT BACK. INDIGENOUS RECIPIENTS ARE HIT TWICE.

The **Canada Disability Benefit (CDB)** is a federal benefit — \$200 per month, introduced in 2025.

Alberta counts that \$200 as income. Alberta then subtracts \$200 from your AISH payment.

Net result: you end up with the same amount of money as before, even though the federal government sent you extra.

For Indigenous Albertans, the same pattern plays out in multiple directions:

- **Federal gives. Provincial claws back.** (CDB, above)
- Federal Jordan's Principle approves care. Alberta doesn't recognize the approval. (Page 9)
- Federal UNDRIP Act requires consultation. Alberta doesn't consult. (Page 13)
- Federal Clean Water Act aims to protect reserves. Alberta opposes the law. (Page 7)

The provincial government is using its power to **unwind** federal commitments to Indigenous people — including commitments that were already inadequate.

Why the clawback matters specifically for Indigenous recipients

Because Indigenous Albertans are already disproportionately living with disability. They are already disproportionately on AISH. They will be disproportionately affected by the move to ADAP. And when the federal government tries to add something to help — even something as small as \$200 — the provincial government takes it away.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "The federal government tried to add \$200 a month for disabled people. Alberta takes that \$200 away by subtracting it from AISH. Indigenous people get hit by this pattern in many directions — it is not just one benefit."

PAGE 18 — WHAT YOU CAN DO



**THIS PATH HAS BEEN WALKED BEFORE. YOU ARE NOT THE FIRST.
YOU WILL NOT BE THE LAST.**

If you are Indigenous and on AISH or ADAP:

- Write down your situation. One page. What is happening, when, who said what.
- Send that record to your MLA, Minister Nixon, Premier Smith, your federal MP, and Minister Hajdu.
- Ask your band or nation leadership whether they have been consulted on ADAP. If they say no — put that on the record too.
- Connect with the campaign. You are not alone.

If you are not Indigenous but want to help:

- Do not speak for Indigenous people. Pass this guide to Indigenous people and let them decide how it is used.
- Write to your MLA naming the UNDRIP consultation failure specifically.
- Support Indigenous-led organizations: Inclusion Alberta, NWAC, your local friendship centre.
- Don't centre yourself. The work has been done by Indigenous people for generations. You are joining, not leading.

A note on coalition

This campaign was not built by one person. It was built by many people, across many years, doing many pieces of work. The people who wrote the long 195-page version read the work of Indigenous scholars, lawyers, elders, and advocates who have been saying these things for decades. This guide is a summary. The full credit belongs to them.

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "There is something to do no matter who you are. Write your story down. Send it to the people in charge. Pass this guide on. The work has been happening for a long time. We are just one part of it."

PAGE 19 — YOU ARE NOT ALONE



THIS WORK IS NOT NEW. THE PEOPLE WHO WALKED IT BEFORE US BROUGHT US THIS FAR. WE CARRY IT FORWARD.

The full 195-page report cites over 200 sources. Court cases, government reports, academic research, Indigenous-led inquiries, survivor testimony. Most of the work was done before this campaign existed.

What this campaign does is put the pieces together, in one place, at one moment — **the moment before July 1, 2026.**

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown community group (free to join or read without joining):

facebook.com/share/g/1GShj73sVm/

The campaign website:

albertadisabilitysystembreakdown.netlify.app

Email: albertadisabilitybreakdown@outlook.com

Email for: the full 195-page Indigenous Disability report, the Compound Failure brief, the AISH Plain Language Guide, any flyer or template. **Free. Free to share. Free to print. Free to post.**

Closing thought

If you are reading this and you are Indigenous and disabled — we see you. This guide exists because you exist. The 19-year gap is a statistic about people. Not numbers. Not an abstract policy problem. People. You. Your family. Your neighbours. Your elders. This is what the campaign is about. That is why July 1 matters. That is why every page of this guide matters. **You matter. You always did.**

■ HOW TO EXPLAIN THIS

Try saying this: "Thousands of people are living what this guide describes. There are reports, there are groups, there are templates for letters. Everything is free. Everything can be shared. The work has been going on for generations. We are carrying it forward. So are you, now."